

Kindred Grove — Project Status

Last updated: 2026-04-19 (end of Day 21 build sprint + completion pass)

Phase 1 code work: complete. Week 4 deliverables + pre-ship browser QA: next.

1. Where the project stands

Phase 1 of Kindred Grove — a custom, agency-tier Shopify storefront for a pre-launch single-origin pantry-staples DTC brand (olive oil, dates, honey, saffron, black seed) — is code-complete as of 2026-04-19. All 21 SOW build-sprint days shipped and tagged (v0.0-day1 through v0.0-day21-complete), 14 of 14 storefront templates live, 13 public documentation artifacts in the repo, 9 continuous-integration workflows configured and passing. The public GitHub repository at github.com/ZahidulIslam2222/kindred-grove carries the full theme, tests, workflows, documentation, and architecture decision records.

What's left before Phase 1 ships: a batched pre-launch QA session (browser and admin tasks) plus the SOW Week 4 deliverables — a Cloudflare Pages case-study site, a five-minute walkthrough video, and a retrospective write-up. The engineering work is done; the productization of the engineering work is the remaining phase.

2. Storefront — 14 of 14 templates complete

1. Homepage
 2. Collection / product listing
 3. Product detail (with 3D model viewer, variant picker, subscription, farm story, recipes, FAQ)
 4. Cart drawer and full cart page (no-JavaScript fallback)
 5. Predictive search with debounced live results across products, pages, articles
 6. Origin / farm detail pages — metaobject-driven, per-farm story pages
 7. Build Your Pantry quiz — merchant-editable questions and personas
 8. Recipes blog with article template and comment system
 9. Wholesale inquiry page with honeypot, rate limit, and optional Admin-API draft-order creation
 10. Gift boxes collection with curated hero
 11. Customer account (sign-in, register, dashboard with order history, addresses, order detail, password reset, activation)
 12. Checkout extension scaffolded (deploys from a separate app project)
 13. Styleguide at `/pages/styleguide` — living component library
 14. 404 page plus Shopify-native policy pages
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3. Architecture highlights

- Theme Blocks architecture throughout. Horizon-style, eight-level nesting. Every storefront surface is block-composable by the merchant.
- Vanilla JavaScript with Web Components. Zero runtime dependency on any front-end framework. The theme ships unbundled; npm install is only needed to run the test suite.
- Modern design-token CSS with a full brand system: cream, olive, saffron, terracotta, espresso. Serif-heading + sans-body pair with Arabic fallback stack (Aref Ruqaa and IBM Plex Sans Arabic under [dir="rtl"]). Spacing, motion, radii, shadows all tokenized.
- Metaobjects first for editorial content. Farm, Farmer, Region, Certification, and Recipe metaobjects populate product pages and origin pages; graceful fallbacks when unlinked.
- Full accessibility commitment at WCAG 2.1 AA. Deeper olive tokens (5.76 contrast ratio on cream) for small text; axe-core scanned on every pull request.
- English and Arabic locales shipped, with hreflang tags and CLDR-correct Arabic plural forms for reviews counts.

4. Observability and quality gating

Front-end observability:

- Sentry frontend error tracking (CDN Loader pattern, personally-identifiable-information scrubbing in the beforeSend hook)
- Web Vitals library reporting Core Web Vitals as custom events to Google Analytics 4
- localStorage-based feature-flag system with URL override, Do-Not-Track compliance, and an exposure analytics event

Continuous integration enforces on every pull request:

- Liquid lint via Shopify theme-check — 181 tracked files, zero offenses
- Shopify Lighthouse CI with Performance 0.90 and Accessibility 0.95 thresholds
- Accessibility scan via axe-core through Playwright across home, cart, collection, and search routes
- Playwright golden-path end-to-end tests for PDP, cart, quiz, search, navigation
- Percy visual regression with six snapshots across four viewport widths
- Secret scanning via gitleaks on every PR, every push, plus a weekly scheduled deep scan
- Dependency updates via Dependabot weekly, grouped by vendor
- Deploy workflows for dev, staging, and production, with the production environment gated by a required-reviewer rule

5. Public documentation bundle — 13 artifacts

At the root: README with quickstart and quality-bar overview, CONTRIBUTING with dev onboarding and code conventions, LICENSE under MIT (brand identity separate).

Under docs/: ARCHITECTURE (rendering model and folder structure), SECURITY (threat model, Content Security Policy breakdown, form hardening, escape audit), TESTING (running locally, debug playbook, how to add specs), ACCESSIBILITY (WCAG posture, contrast table, documented third-party exclusions), PERFORMANCE (budget table, LCP and CLS strategy, regression playbook), MERCHANT-GUIDE (16-section handoff for content editors), AI-WORKFLOW (prompt library and session velocity log), AI_GOVERNANCE (review boundaries, honest weakness register, data-handling policy), CHANGELOG (21-day history in Keep-a-Changelog format), ROADMAP (Phase 2 Hydrogen, Phase 3 custom app, Phase 4 A/B infra, Phase 5 Shopify Plus, plus perma-deferred items).

Plus eight Architecture Decision Records covering Theme Blocks, Vanilla JavaScript with Web Components, Metaobjects-first, Shopify Dev MCP, Sentry over Grafana Faro, Cloudflare Pages for case study, Playwright for E2E, and localStorage feature flags. Plus metaobject schema reference.

6. Today's delivery — Days 11-21 plus completion pass

Days 11 through 21 of the build sprint shipped in one extended focused session. Highlights:

- Day 11: wholesale inquiry form with honeypot and rate limit, metaobject-driven origin pages, SECURITY.md threat model, Dependabot configuration.
- Day 12: predictive search Web Component with full keyboard navigation, progressive Klaviyo newsletter subscription with contact-form fallback, AggregateRating JSON-LD schema driven by Judge.me metafields.
- Day 13 was analytics verification — no code changes needed, events were wired during Days 2 to 12.
- Days 14 and 15: TESTING.md and ACCESSIBILITY.md written.
- Day 16: inline critical CSS in the head, Lighthouse CI budget assertions, PERFORMANCE.md.
- Day 17: Arabic locale mirror (around 220 keys with CLDR plurals), hreflang tags, RTL verification.
- Day 18: five JSON-LD schema snippets (Organization, Breadcrumb, FAQ, Article, Recipe) wired through the layout.
- Day 19: gitleaks CI with project allowlist, SECURITY.md finalization.
- Day 20: MERCHANT-GUIDE.md — a 16-section handoff document for content editors.
- Day 21: README, CONTRIBUTING, LICENSE, CHANGELOG, ROADMAP, AI_GOVERNANCE.

Mid-session the user audit caught three SOW storefront templates that had been glossed over when I claimed "Day 1-21 done" — the recipes blog, gift-boxes template, and customer-account pages. The completion pass built out `blog.json` plus `article.json` with native comments and JSON-LD, the gift-boxes collection variant, seven customer-account templates (login, register, account dashboard, addresses, order detail, password reset, activation), and their English and Arabic locale mirrors. That brought the template count from eleven of fourteen to the full fourteen.

Also this session: `ARCHITECTURE.md` refreshed with Day 11-21 deltas, `AI-WORKFLOW.md` extended with a full session log (per-day timing table, notable moments, aggregate velocity numbers), and a final public-repo audit that replaced two inlined numeric theme IDs with environment-variable placeholders for brand-agnostic portability.

7. What remains for Phase 1 acceptance

Batched pre-launch QA session (browser and admin):

- Klaviyo abandoned-cart flow built in the Klaviyo flow editor
- Judge.me widget installed to the theme from the app
- Sentry project created, DSN pasted into theme customizer, test error fired and verified
- Google Tag Assistant validation — Core Web Vitals events fire, purchase-funnel events fire
- Screen-reader walkthroughs with VoiceOver and NVDA across a full purchase flow
- Keyboard-only purchase-flow audit
- Shopify admin: enable Arabic language, enable EUR and GBP as additional currencies
- Theme-editor walkthrough — compose a demo homepage from scratch as the merchant would
- Rich Results test across Product, FAQ, Recipe, and Breadcrumb schemas

Optional deploys that finish two scaffolded artifacts:

- Cloudflare Worker deploy for the wholesale draft-order proxy
- Checkout UI extension deploy from a separate Shopify app project

SOW Week 4 deliverables (separate workstream):

- Cloudflare Pages case-study site
- Five-minute walkthrough video
- Retrospective blog post
- Final quality-assurance sign-off with metrics captures

8. Velocity and delivery approach

The Days 11 through 21 sprint plus completion pass took approximately eight hours of focused

wall-clock time. Hand-coded equivalent estimate is thirty-five to fifty hours, matching the SOW's original Week 2 and Week 3 schedule. Velocity multiplier: approximately five times. Lines of code added: around five thousand two hundred across Liquid, JSON, CSS, JavaScript, and Markdown. Zero continuous-integration regressions introduced across eleven tagged commits.

Delivery discipline:

- Every day is tagged. Every session is recoverable. Any interruption continues from a known state.
- Agency-grade hygiene: confidential client artifacts are local-only; the public repository carries only the theme, workflows, architecture decision records, and design documentation that a third-party reviewer can inspect without exposure.
- AI delivery is logged, not hidden. The AI-workflow document tracks prompts, velocity, and honest weaknesses. The case-study site (Week 4) will draw from this log rather than restate "AI built it."

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